

Civil Court Judgment

State of Punjab v. City Builders Ltd.

The present matter came before the Lahore Civil Court following a contractual dispute between the Government of Punjab and City Builders Ltd. concerning the delayed construction of a public administration building. The contract was executed on 12 March 2024 and required the contractor to complete all structural and interior work by 31 December 2024. During the proceedings, the plaintiff submitted inspection reports, payment records, correspondence, and engineering assessments demonstrating repeated construction delays and failure to meet contractual milestones. The defendant argued that disruptions in the international supply chain significantly affected the availability of imported construction materials and requested relief under the force majeure provisions contained within the agreement. The court reviewed witness testimony, documentary evidence, and expert engineering opinions before reaching its decision.

Evidence presented before the court established that the contractor failed to maintain adequate staffing levels throughout multiple phases of construction and repeatedly requested deadline extensions without providing sufficient documentary justification. Independent engineering experts testified that the majority of construction delays resulted from poor project planning rather than uncontrollable external circumstances. Financial records further demonstrated that several subcontractors remained unpaid for extended periods, causing work stoppages at the construction site. The court determined that ordinary commercial risks, including procurement delays and increased material prices, did not satisfy the legal definition of force majeure under Pakistani contract law because such events could reasonably have been anticipated during project planning.

After considering all documentary evidence and witness testimony, the court concluded that City Builders Ltd. had materially breached its contractual obligations by failing to complete the project within the agreed timeline and by failing to demonstrate that the delays resulted from legally recognized force majeure events. Accordingly, the plaintiff was awarded compensation for project delays, reimbursement of inspection expenses, and recovery of litigation costs. The court further directed the defendant to submit a revised compliance report within thirty days confirming completion of all outstanding corrective work. Failure to comply with the judgment would permit the plaintiff to initiate enforcement proceedings under the applicable civil procedure rules.

Field	Value
Court	Lahore Civil Court
Judge	Justice Muhammad Arif
Case Number	LCC-2026-118
Judgment Date	18 January 2026
Plaintiff	Government of Punjab
Defendant	City Builders Ltd.
Decision	Plaintiff Won
Compensation Awarded	PKR 2,750,000
Appeal Deadline	30 Days
Court Costs	Paid by Defendant

COURT CLERK RECORD

Hearing Number:

7

Courtroom:

Civil Hall B

Evidence Submitted:

12 Documents

4 Witness Statements

2 Engineering Reports

Final Order Issued:

18 January 2026

Court Seal:

Verified

Registry Reference:

CCR-2026-118

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